

INITIAL ASSESSMENT OF THE PATIENT

Give urgent attention to the patient with any of:

- Decreased consciousness
- Fitting
- Difficulty breathing or breathless while talking
- Respiratory rate ≥ 30 breaths/minute
- Chest pain
- Headache *and* vomiting
- Aggressive, confused or agitated
- Overdose of drugs/medication
- Recent sexual assault
- Vomiting or coughing blood
- Bleeding
- Burn
- Eye injury
- Severe pain
- Suspected fracture or joint dislocation
- Recent sudden onset weakness, numbness or visual disturbance
- Unable to pass urine
- Sudden facial swelling
- Pregnant *with* abdominal pain/vaginal bleeding
- Purple/red rash that does not disappear with gentle pressure

Management:

- Check and record BP, pulse, respiratory rate and temperature and ensure patient is urgently seen by nurse or doctor.
- If decreased consciousness, fitting, confused, unable to sit up or known diabetic, also check glucose.

Do routine prep room tests on the patient not needing urgent attention

- Routinely check and record weight, BP, pulse and temperature.
- If coughing/difficulty breathing, also check respiratory rate.
- If known diabetic *and* feeling unwell, also check glucose.

Ensure the patient with any of the following is seen promptly by nurse or doctor:

- BP $\geq 180/110$ or BP $< 90/60$
- Pulse irregular, ≥ 100 or < 50
- Respiratory rate ≥ 30
- Oxygen saturation $< 92\%$ at rest
- Pregnant with BP $\geq 140/90$
- Temperature $\geq 38^\circ\text{C}$
- Glucose < 3 (or < 4 if diabetic) or ≥ 11.1
- Oxygen saturation drop to $< 87\%$ on exertion (walking 15-20m)

Continue to assess the pregnant patient and the patient with hypertension and/or diabetes:

Patient is pregnant

Check at booking visit:

- Mid Upper Arm Circumference (MUAC)
- Height to calculate BMI¹
- Hb
- Rapid rhesus
- Syphilis

Check at every visit:

- BP
- Urine dipstick
- Fingerprick glucose *only* if glucose on urine dipstick
- HIV

Patient has hypertension

Check at every visit:

- BP
- At first visit also check height to calculate BMI¹.

Check once a year:

- Weight, waist circumference (also check 3 monthly if trying to lose weight)
- Urine dipstick
- Fingerprick glucose (also check if glucose on urine dipstick)

Patient has diabetes

Check at every visit:

- BP
 - Fingerprick glucose (only if unwell or not yet stable on medications)
 - Urine dipstick *only* if fingerprick glucose ≥ 11.1
- At first visit also check height to calculate BMI¹.

Check once a year:

- Weight, waist circumference (also check 3 monthly if trying to lose weight)
- Urine dipstick
- Visual acuity

¹BMI = weight (kg) $\div$ height (m) $\div$ height (m).